THE FOOD GRANNY



Because someone had to tell the story with tea and honesty

Sustainable Revenue • Audience Growth Strategy

Authentic Stories.
Lasting Impact.

Christine Smith

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I. Introduction

1.1 Problem Statement

Christine runs her brand, **The Food Granny**, entirely on her own. She writes, records, and publishes every story herself. Her content is completely free of charge to build trust with her audience, but this makes it difficult to cover her ongoing **website hosting and podcast production costs**.

Christine needs partners and sponsors to help cover these expenses without turning it into a heavier, full-time commitment. She also faces a reach limitation as her voice has not yet connected with the Adelaide audience actively seeking local businesses known for quality, originality, creativity, and custom work.

Without steady funding and a wider reach, Christine may be forced to stop. If she does, local businesses will lose an authentic voice dedicated to putting them in the spotlight.

II. Christine's Current Brand Position

Channel	What the numbers show	What it means to her brand
Instagram @thefoodgranny	→ 2,188 followers. Reels, carousels and photos. Irregular posting. Engagement needs a login.	Instagram gives her the best local reach and already carries the "Behind the Counter" name. A more consistent style and focus would show businesses what she offers
X @theFoodGranny	→ 2,243 followers. 44,700 posts. Little or no response.	X carries the most personal voice, but the time invested goes largely unrecognised. The posts are spread too thinly across topics to reach the small business stories at the heart of the work.
Website thefoodgranny.com.au	→ Links to Instagram, LinkedIn, X, Facebook and Substack	The website is the home base. It says plainly what the work is and links to all the other channels, but a business owner who arrives has no clear way to start working together.
LinkedIn Christine Smith	→ 500+ connections. 1 to 6 reactions and up to 3 comments per post.	LinkedIn has a smaller audience, but it is the likeliest place to meet sponsors and partners. Her experience and awards carry weight, though the reposts crowd out the original writing.
Substack From Forks to Footprints	→ About 60 subscribers and 8 recommendations. Minimal response.	Substack is small, but it suits the long-form writing and builds a list that the writer owns. The name doesn't match the brand, and only a few readers find it.
Podcast The Food Granny	→ 8 episodes, 12 to 41 downloads each. Latest in May 2026	The podcast celebrates small businesses, local producers and South Australian communities, and suits the voice. But the old name and the gap since May make it look stopped.
Facebook The Food Granny	→ 179 members. Not active.	The platform is not part of her plan, so the focus stays on the channels she trusts.
TikTok @thefoodgranny	→ Audience unknown. Not active.	TikTok is only an idea for now.

III. Target Audience

The Food Granny serves two distinct layers of audience. The first is **a content audience:** the readers, listeners and followers who engage with Christine's stories across her digital platforms. The second is a **potential customer base: businesses and government organizations** that may pay for Christine's storytelling services. The size and engagement of the content audience is what gives Christine's platform value to potential customers.
Christine maintains a presence across several platforms including LinkedIn, Instagram, Substack, Facebook and others, with detailed engagement data available for a subset of these (see Section 2). The personas below are composites based on the client consultation and Christine's published content. They represent typical members of each audience segment rather than specific individuals.

3.1 Content Audience



→ Christine's content audience consists of people who follow, read or listen to The Food Granny's stories about local food, hospitality and community in South Australia.
→ These followers do not pay for Christine's services, but their engagement is what demonstrates the platform's reach and influence on potential paying customers.

No verified demographic breakdown of this audience is available from platform analytics. The description below reflects Christine's professional observation of her following (client consultation, 2026) rather than a verified audience profile.



Sarah Mitchell

Age: 34

Location: Adelaide, South Australia

Occupation: Marketing coordinator at a local nonprofit

Background
Sarah actively seeks out authentic, locally made products and businesses rather than big brands. She scrolls Instagram and LinkedIn looking for real stories, not algorithm-fed ads.

Primary Goals
Discover local food producers and businesses she has not heard of before. Stay connected with what is happening in Adelaide's food and small business community. Share stories with friends and colleagues that feel genuine rather than promotional.

How She Engages
Sarah reads Christine's LinkedIn posts and Substack articles during her commute. She occasionally shares a story with her team at work or tags a friend on Instagram. She does not pay for content, but her engagement contributes to the metrics that demonstrate The Food Granny's reach to potential business clients.

3.2 Potential Customers

Small and micro businesses



→ Christine describes her professional network as "mainly women-led startups, 28 to 40 years old" operating in Adelaide and across South Australia (client consultation, 2026).
→ These are businesses Christine already has a personal connection with, either as a customer or through shared values.
→ They include food producers, hospitality operators and makers at various stages of growth.
→ Many of these businesses need affordable and accessible ways to reach new customers but have limited time, budgets and marketing support to do so on their own.

A detailed analysis of their needs and the implications for service design is presented in the customer empathy map (Section 9).



Priya Nandan

Age: 32

Location: Adelaide, South Australia

Occupation: Founder of a small artisan food business

Background
Priya is a women-led startup operator in Adelaide, the type of business owner Christine already has a personal connection with, either as a customer or through shared values. She handles most of her own marketing but has limited time, budget and expertise to tell her brand story effectively.

Primary Goals
Attract new customers beyond her existing market stall regulars. Find an affordable way to promote her business that does not require significant time or marketing expertise. Get her brand story told in a way that feels authentic and connects with people who value locally made products.

Why The Food Granny
Priya has seen Christine feature businesses like hers and noticed that those stories feel personal rather than like an advertisement. She is interested in what Christine offers but would need to understand the cost and time commitment before deciding.

3.3 Government and institutional bodies



→ During the client consultation, Christine noted that local councils have previously approached her about storytelling projects, and she has received enquiries from South Australian tourism bodies and community media organizations.
→ These organizations represent a separate customer segment with different procurement processes, longer timescales and larger budgets.

Their participation is more likely to take the form of grants or funded commissions than direct purchase of a service package. Available grant pathways are examined in Section 6.
No formal engagement has taken place with any of these bodies. The evidence for this segment is limited to Christine's account of informal interest.



David Chen

Age: 45

Location: Adelaide, South Australia

Occupation: Community development officer at a local council

Background
David represents the type of decision-maker found in local councils, government grant bodies and community media organizations such as the Community Broadcasting Foundation (CBF) and the City of Adelaide. These bodies are key for sponsorship and grant strategy, even though they are not everyday content consumers.

Primary Goals
Find local creators who can produce authentic content that promotes the region's food and small business scene. Support initiatives that help local businesses grow their visibility. Deliver projects that demonstrate community impact within a limited budget.

How He Might Engage
David would not purchase a standard service package. His involvement would more likely take the form of a grant, a funded commission or a partnership arrangement where the council sponsors a series of stories about local businesses in the region. His decision-making process involves internal approvals and would take longer than a direct business-to-business transaction.

3.4 Limitations

→ No follower demographic data is available from any platform's backend analytics. Audience descriptions in this section rely on the client's own observation.
→ No potential paying customers have been directly interviewed or surveyed. Customer needs are inferred from the client consultation and Christine's published content.
→ Evidence of government and institutional interest is limited to the client's account of informal enquiries. No procurement documentation or formal expressions of interest have been reviewed.

The personas above are composites constructed from available evidence. They are intended to represent typical members of each audience segment, not verified customer profiles.

IV. SWOT Analysis

This section brings together the findings from the earlier sections into one view of The Food Granny's position. It sets out the strengths and weaknesses within the business, and the opportunities and threats around it. The analysis draws on the platform data and brand positioning (Section 2), the audience profiles (Section 3), the market and grant research (Sections 5 and 6), the regional platform mapping (Section 7), gap analysis and competitive benchmarks (Section 8) and the service options (Section 9).

The SWOT looks at both audience layers: the readers, listeners and followers who engage with her stories, and the businesses and organisations that may pay for her storytelling. The size and response of the first group decide how much value she can offer the second. The analysis therefore asks what she does well, where she is held back, and which opportunities she can realistically take while keeping her voice and a manageable workload.

The findings rest on the client consultation, her published content and the market research. No audience demographic data is available, and no potential paying clients have been interviewed. The analysis should be read with those limits in mind.

Strengths

S

A distinctive voice. Her stories feel personal, not promotional. Business owners notice this, and it is what separates her from paid advertising.

Local roots. She focuses on food, hospitality and community in South Australia. She already has personal connections with women-led startups and with Adelaide community FM stations.

Proven storytelling. She has featured businesses such as Woodlane Pantry and Discover Adelaide Tours, with a focus on the people and purpose behind each one.

An efficient process. One story takes her about 2.5 hours from interview to finished article.

Low running costs. They are at most $300 a month, and she wants to cover them, not make a large profit. A small income is therefore enough.

Credibility. Her experience, awards and community work carry weight on LinkedIn. As a women-led South Australian business, she is eligible for several grants.

Weaknesses

Small audiences and low response. Substack has about 60 subscribers, podcast episodes get 12 to 41 downloads, and LinkedIn posts get 1 to 6 reactions. X has about 2,243 followers but little or no response.

Channels that don't work as one brand. Names, style and topics change from one channel to the next. The podcast and Substack don't use "Behind the Counter" or The Food Granny name.

W

A podcast that looks stopped. The last episode came out in May 2026.

No clear way in for businesses. The website says what she does, but it gives no obvious way to work with her. Her stories are currently free, and she has no formal offer or prices.

Gaps in the evidence. No audience demographic data is available, and no potential paying clients have been interviewed.

Opportunities

O

A gap in the market. Micro businesses can't afford the large outlets, and many can't write their own story. A well-written, affordable story from her fills that gap.

A simple first product. A Behind the Counter Story at $150, or an $80 Short Story, followed by a monthly partnership if the trial works.

Grants and mentoring.

Women in Business Foundations is open now, The City of Adelaide Major Round closes on 23 October 2026 and needs a public, in-person component in the city, CBF Content Grants open in January 2027, Campbelltown Small Business Grants follow around February 2027, FoundHer opens around mid-2027, offering $20,000 or $30,000.

AI support. AI can transcribe interviews, suggest quotes and check spelling, while she writes every sentence herself.

More from each interview. Once she has a producer, one interview can become an article, an episode and short clips.

Growing audio interest. 55% of Australians aged 10 and over listen to podcasts each month (Edison Research, 2026).

Interest from institutions. Councils, tourism bodies and community media have approached her informally.

Threats

T

Large competitors. InDaily SA (452,000 monthly readers) and CityMag (70,000) already sell sponsored and bespoke stories, with far more reach and production resources.

Untested willingness to pay. Small businesses have tight budgets, and no one has yet been asked what they would pay.

An audience too small for sponsors. At current download numbers, selling podcast advertising would earn about $1 to $3 an episode.

Workload. Regular clients mean regular deadlines, which could reduce the flexibility she wants.

Grants that don’t last. They are competitive and time-consuming, and they give one-off money, not regular income. Some need a partner, a co-contribution or a city-based project.

Trust. Paid stories must be clearly labelled (AANA Code of Ethics). If commercial work starts to shape her stories, it could weaken the authentic voice that makes her different.

Informal institutional interest. There is no procurement documentation or formal expression of interest from councils or tourism bodies.

Thus, the business has a strong voice, a local focus and low costs. It is held back by small audiences, scattered channels and no clear offer. The best opportunity is a simple, affordable story for small businesses, supported by grants and AI. The main threats are the larger outlets and the risk of more work than she wants.

V. Market Sponsorship Models and Price Benchmarks

Research objective

Identify sponsorship models that could help Christine cover operating costs while preserving her personal voice and keeping administration manageable. The supplied project document reports 12–41 podcast downloads per episode and 60 Substack subscribers (Sponsorship Model Research, n.d.). Therefore, while examining audience reach, this study also scrutinizes the value of storytelling and the cultivation of local relationships.

Research scope

Compare three main models: a fixed fee for one episode; sponsorship of a season or defined period; and commissioned business stories sold as articles, audio features or combined packages. For each, examine sponsor benefits, pricing, delivery commitments, content independence and workload.

Focusing primarily on independent podcasts and regional media in Adelaide and South Australia as the sample. Treat sponsorship marketplaces as sales channels and grants as supplementary funding, rather than equivalent sponsorship models.

Step	Research activity
Step 1 Clarify client needs	Confirm monthly costs, available production hours, acceptable sponsor types and editorial boundaries.
Step 2 Collect candidate cases	Search official sponsorship pages, media kits, rate cards, program notes and labelled sponsored articles. Build an initial list of 8–10 candidates.
Step 3 Select comparable samples	Choose five useful cases based on content format, operating model, and evidence of quality. Record audience differences.
Step 4 Compare the arrangements	Record price, currency, GST, term, deliverables, sponsor rights and workload. Separate advertised fees from actual deal values.
Step 5 Assess practical fit	Compare likely cost recovery, sales effort, repeat income and content control against Christine's circumstances.

Practical examples and supporting evidence

Five published offers illustrate different commercial structures. Four state numerical prices; CityMag describes a custom content service without a quoted fee. Prices below retain the sources' dollar notation and stated GST treatment. They are advertised offers, not evidence of completed sales. The public sources were checked on 8 October 2026.

The Parenting Couch. North Shore Mums (n.d.) advertises one episode with a post-roll advertisement for $650 plus GST, or three episodes for $950 plus GST. Each option includes a one-off $500 creative fee, host-read advertising, and a banner on the article promoting the episode. The rate calculation assumes 2,000 downloads per episode.

This structure shows how production and repeats placement charges can be separated, but the audience difference limits its use as a pricing benchmark for The Food Granny.

Glam Adelaide. The historical 2024 Fringe artist package lists a discounted Core package at $600 plus GST, Gold at $3,000 plus GST and Platinum at $6,000 plus GST. The Core offer combines a feature article, newsletter and social promotion, and display advertising (Glam Adelaide, n.d., pp. 3–4). It illustrates how several distribution channels can be sold together. The prices relate to a festival promotion and should not be treated as a current quotation.

What's On In Adelaide. The online media kit lists $100 for one week of homepage and social promotion. Its $400 option extends promotion to four weeks and adds a homepage banner, a competition or alternative shared post, and newsletter inclusion (What's On In Adelaide, n.d.). The undated page does not specify GST treatment. These tiers offer a simple example of increasing duration and benefits, although event promotion involves different work from creating an original business story.

2RPH. The Program Sponsor package is advertised at $1,000 per week with a minimum commitment of 13 weeks. Benefits include exclusive radio and podcast program sponsorship, opening and closing sponsor messages, ten additional spots per week and content for the sponsor's social channels (2RPH, n.d.). The page does not specify GST treatment. The fixed term offers a useful model for recurring commitments, but the broadcaster's scale and delivery requirements differ substantially from Christine's operation.

CityMag. Solstice Media's (n.d.) media kit describes custom stories, photography, illustration and campaign design. Sponsored print content is also published online and included in the weekly email newsletter at no additional charge (p. 9). The kit does not list a numerical fee for this service, so an actual price would require a quotation. Its local business storytelling approach makes it relevant to The Food Granny, while its production resources limit direct cost comparisons.

Excepted outputs and preliminary assessment

Deliver a five-case comparison, linked evidence, and two or three practical options: a paid story, a short series of sponsorship, or a limited article–audio–social package. For each, specify inclusions, workload, pricing basis and trade-offs. Trial prices should reflect her production costs and prospective clients' willingness to pay.

Market Price Comparison

Please refer to table 1 and figure 1 below. Based on the collected Australian market data, there are clear price differences between different types of sponsorship and media content. A simple sponsored Instagram post or editorial feature costs around $200, while a contextual mention costs around $249. When the content becomes a full sponsored post, multi-channel package or email promotion, the price increases significantly to around $495–$899. This shows that sponsorship prices increase as the content becomes more detailed, uses more promotion channels and provides more brand exposure. For The Food Granny, these examples can be used as market references, but the final price should still be adjusted based on her audience size and actual production workload.

Table 1

Platform / Example	Price (AUD)	Format
homeintheworld	200	Instagram sponsored post
Buggybuddys Editorial Feature	200	Editorial feature
Rachel's List Contextual Mention	249	Contextual mention
Buggybuddys Platinum Package	495	Multi-channel package
Rachel's List Sponsored Post	499	Sponsored written post
Rachel's List Sponsored Post + eDM	799	Sponsored post + eDM
Rachel's List Sales Email	899	Dedicated sales email

Figure 1



Content Format Ranges

Please refer to table 2 and figure 2. From the price ranges, there are clear differences in the prices of different content types. A basic blog post has the lowest price, at around $300–$450. A complex blog post costs around $400–$800, while a long-form blog is the most expensive, at around $800–$1,500. A newsletter / eDM costs around $200–$600. This shows that more complex and longer content usually requires more research, interviews, writing and editing time, so the market price is usually higher. For The Food Granny, Christine's main content is long-form storytelling, so her pricing should not be based only on simple social media posts. It should also consider the actual production workload and the depth of the content.

Table 2

Content type	Low (AUD)	High (AUD)
Basic blog post	300	450
Complex blog post	400	800
Long-form blog	800	1500
Newsletter / eDM	200	600

Figure 2



Why do different sponsorships and content types have different prices?

Table 3

Pricing driver	Effect on price	Meaning for The Food Granny
Content format	Longer and more complex formats cost more	Long-form stories should be priced above a simple social post
Production effort	Research, interviews and editing increase price	Christine should include time and workload in pricing
Number of channels	More channels increase sponsor value	Article + email/social can justify a higher fixed price
Audience size	Larger reach can support higher prices	Do not directly copy prices from much larger platforms
Engagement / niche fit	Relevant audiences can add value	Local Adelaide relevance is an important strength
Exclusivity	Category exclusivity can justify a premium	Can be considered later

Indicative Market Price Range:

Please refer to Figure 3 below. The market data above shows that similar content and sponsorship services in Australia usually have higher market prices. Based on The Food Granny's current platform size and Christine's main goal at this stage, the focus is on covering costs rather than making a high profit. Based on The Food Granny's current platform size and Christine's main goal at this stage, the focus is on covering costs rather than making a high profit. Therefore, it is recommended to start with a lower trial price to test how willing local businesses are to pay. Once Christine completed 2–3 paid commissions, adjust rates based on the actual workload, users' feedback and the performance of the content.

Figure 3

Package	Recommended Trial Price	Inclusions
Short Story	AUD $80/story	A simplified written feature with limited production time, designed as a low-entry option for small local businesses
Behind the Counter Story	AUD $150/story	A complete story-based feature combining interview, long-form writing and selected social promotion
Monthly Partnership	AUD $130/month	A recurring content arrangement with one story each month, offering a lower monthly rate in return for a three-month commitment
Expanded Package	Future option – TBC	A higher-value package that may combine written content, newsletter exposure and additional social channels as the audience grows

VI. South Australia Grant Funding and Community Media Partnerships

Government grants and funded programs relevant to The Food Granny's commercial development, based on eligibility, timing, and alignment with Christine's platform.

Seven state and local government programs were identified across SA small business grants and community media funding streams. Two (CreateSA Projects and CreateSA Professional Development) were excluded because podcasts are not listed among their eligible artforms, leaving five programs with high or medium fit for The Food Granny's platform.

Program Overview

Program	Fit	Type	Funding	Next Round
FoundHer Grant Program	High	Cash grant	$20,000 Launch (×4) or $30,000 Elevate (×1)	Mid-2027 (est.)
Women in Business Foundations	High	Mentoring	$220 subsidized fee (6 sessions)	Currently open
Campbelltown Small Business Grants	Medium	Cash grant	Up to $5,000 (requires 1:1 co-contribution)	~Feb 2027 (est.)
City of Adelaide Community Grants	Medium	Cash grant	$2,000 to $20,000	Major Round closes 23 Oct 2026
CBF Content Grants	Medium	Cash grant	Varies by project scope	Round 1, Jan 2027

Small Business Grants

1. FoundHer Grant Program *[High Fit]*

Administered by: SA Office for Women, Government of South Australia
Funding: $20,000 Launch Grants (4 available per round) and one $30,000 Elevate Grant
Eligibility: Women-led small businesses registered in South Australia, operating for at least 12 months with an ABN

Timeline: Most recent round closed 14 August 2026. The program runs annually (replacing the former Fearless Innovator Grant). Next round expected mid-2027.

This is the strongest funding opportunity identified. The program's purpose is to support women-led SA businesses in validating and growing their commercial models. Christine's platform fits the eligibility criteria: The Food Granny is a women-led South Australian business with a clear content-based service offering that is moving toward commercial viability.

The $20,000 Launch Grant could fund the development of a media kit, production of a first paid podcast season, or investment in the tools and processes needed to transition from unpaid to paid content.

Assessment criteria include business viability, growth potential, and the applicant's commitment to the business.

Eligible expenses include equipment and technology, professional development and training, marketing and brand development, and business advisory services.

2. Women in Business Foundations Program *[High Fit]*

Administered by:	SA Office for Women, via business.gov.au
What it provides:	Up to 6 specialist mentoring sessions, including advisory support on business strategy, pricing, and commercial structuring
Cost:	$220 subsidised program fee
Eligibility:	Women-led small businesses in South Australia
Timeline:	Currently open. Program runs until 30 June 2027 (subject to renewal).

This program provides professional advisory support rather than funding. For Christine, who has described a preference for simple business processes and a discomfort with complex commercial negotiation, specialist mentoring could be more immediately useful than a lump sum. The sessions could help Christine structure a service offering, set pricing, and develop a simple client engagement process, all areas where the platform currently has no formalised approach.

The program is currently open and has a low barrier to entry. It can run alongside a FoundHer Grant application.

3. Campbelltown Small Business Grants *[Medium Fit]*

Administered by:	Campbelltown City Council, South Australia
Funding:	Up to $5,000, with a required 1:1 co-contribution from the applicant
Eligibility:	New and established businesses operating in the Campbelltown Council area. Christine has confirmed she is located within this council area.
Timeline:	Opens twice yearly (February and August). Most recent round closed 31 August 2026. Next round expected ~February 2027.

A smaller, locally administered program. The co-contribution requirement means Christine would need to match the grant dollar for dollar, so a $5,000 grant requires $5,000 of her own funds. Eligible activities include innovation, expansion, and business development, which could cover production equipment, website improvements, or marketing materials.

The program's appeal is its local focus and shorter application process compared to state-level grants. Assessment criteria favour businesses that demonstrate community benefit and local economic impact, both of which align with The Food Granny's focus on telling Adelaide business stories.

Community Media and Arts Partnerships

1. City of Adelaide Community Grants *[Medium Fit]*

Administered by: City of Adelaide
Funding: $2,000 to $20,000 per project

Eligibility: Projects delivering arts, culture, or community impact within the City of Adelaide. The applicant does not need to be based in the CBD, but all funded activities must have a physical, public-facing outcome within the City of Adelaide.

Timeline: Major Round closes 23 October 2026. Quick Response Grants open throughout the year (up to $2,000).

The City of Adelaide funds community impact projects under its Arts and Culture focus area. A podcast or written content series that highlights local Adelaide businesses could fit this category, particularly if framed as a project that strengthens connections between the community and local business owners.

The key constraint is geographic. The applicant does not need to be based in the CBD, but the funded project must have a physical outcome within the City of Adelaide that is open to the public. This means the project would need to include a component, such as a live event, recording session, or community workshop, that takes place within the City of Adelaide area. Content production done entirely from home or at locations outside this area would not satisfy this requirement
.
The 2025/26 Major Round funded 20 projects from a total pool of $429,000. The Major Round deadline of 23 October 2026 is the nearest of any program listed here. Quick Response Grants (up to $2,000) are available on a rolling basis and have a simpler application process.

2. CBF Content Grants *[Medium Fit]*

Administered by: Community Broadcasting Foundation
Funding: Varies by project scope and category

Eligibility: Requires partnership with an ACMA-licensed community broadcasting organization. Christine has confirmed an existing relationship with Adelaide community FM stations.

Timeline: Round 1 opens January 2027

CBF Content Grants fund the production of content for community broadcasting. The application requires a partnership with a licensed community broadcaster, which acts as the lead applicant. Christine's confirmed relationship with Adelaide community FM stations is a prerequisite for this path.

This grant would position The Food Granny's podcast content as community media rather than independent publishing. The fit is medium because it introduces a dependency on a partner organization, which adds operational complexity. However, it could provide both funding and a distribution channel through community radio, potentially expanding the podcast audience beyond its current direct subscribers.

The partnership model means Christine would not apply alone. The community station would lead the application, and the content would need to serve the station's audience and programming objectives as well as Christine's editorial goals.

Window	Program	Action Required
Now	Women in Business Foundations	Register and begin mentoring sessions. No deadline pressure.
Oct 2026	City of Adelaide (Major Round)	Application closes 23 October 2026. Requires an in-person CBD component.
Jan 2027	CBF Content Grants (Round 1)	Confirm FM station partnership and prepare joint application.
~Feb 2027	Campbelltown Small Business Grants	Prepare application. Budget for 1:1 co-contribution.
Mid-2027	FoundHer Grant Program	Largest funding pool. Annual program, most recent round closed August 2026.

Trade-offs

Funding vs. Effort. Grant applications require time and documentation. The FoundHer Grant offers the largest funding ($20,000 to $30,000) but involves a competitive application with detailed business planning. The Campbelltown grant is smaller but faster to apply for.

Independence vs. Partnership. The CBF Content Grant and City of Adelaide grant both involve external stakeholders (a community broadcaster, or a CBD venue). These partnerships can expand reach but add coordination and may shape what content gets produced.

One-off vs. Recurring. Grants provide lump-sum funding, not ongoing income. They are best used to fund the setup costs of a commercial model (building a media kit, producing a first paid season) rather than as a substitute for sustainable revenue

Timing. The Women in Business Foundations program is available now. The City of Adelaide deadline is weeks away. All other programs open in 2027. Christine can pursue the immediate options while preparing for the larger opportunities.

Grants provide lumpsum or time-limited support. None of the five programs listed here offer recurring funding. Their role in a commercial transition depends on how they interact with the sponsorship and service packaging models assessed elsewhere in this report.

VII. Regional Platform Mapping

We mapped three South Australian platforms that small business owners read: InDaily SA (Solstice Media, n.d.-b), CityMag (Solstice Media, n.d.-a) and the SA Business Chamber (South Australian Business Chamber, n.d.). We added The Adelaide Show (Davis, 2013), an independent Adelaide podcast, because it is the closest to Christine's scale. We replaced Flying Solo from our draft because it is national, and the brief asked for South Australian platforms. All four earn from **stories about people and businesses**, not from audience size alone.

7.1 Content Format

Writing carries most of business stories in South Australia. Three of the four platforms lead articles and newsletters.

Platform	Main formats	How often
InDaily SA	News articles, specialty newsletters (e.g. Business Insight), social posts	Daily
CityMag	Long-form stories, free print magazine, newsletter, social posts	Weekly online and newsletter; print issues
SA Business Chamber	Weekly member newsletter, events, member profile video	Weekly
The Adelaide Show	Interview podcast with full written show notes, short preview video, email	New episode every 2–3 weeks (440 episodes by Sept 2026)
The Food Granny	Long-form articles, short podcast (paused), Instagram, LinkedIn	Irregular; last episode May 2026

7.2 Audience

A small, loyal audience can sustain a platform, but it does not pay for it on its own.

Platform	Who it serves	Disclosed audience
InDaily SA	Adelaide decisionmakers and business leaders	452k monthly readers; 58k newsletter subscribers; 14k Instagram; 7k LinkedIn

CityMag	Adelaide's independent hospitality, creative and retail scene	70k monthly online audience; 52k newsletter subscribers; 40k print readers; 22k Instagram
SA Business Chamber	Member businesses across SA	3,000+ paying members
The Adelaide Show	South Australians following local people and passions	500–1,000 downloads per episode; listeners mostly aged 25–54, 56% female
The Food Granny	Readers seeking local hidden gems; women-led small businesses	~60 Substack subscribers; 12–41 downloads per episode; ~2,200 Instagram

The Adelaide Show has run for over a decade with roughly 20 to 40 times Christine's podcast audience yet describes itself as a "labour of love" (Davis, 2013). Christine should expect her podcast to build reputation and connections and earn her income elsewhere.

7.3 Monetization

The bigger platforms sell versions of Christine's product, but not in a form that suits a micro business.

7.3.1 Packaging options: what to offer first

We recommend Christine **starts with one paid product: a Behind the Counter Story at $150**, sold to businesses she already knows. Christine has told us her running costs are at most $300 a month while she wants to keep prices low and cover her costs rather than make a profit. **Two stories a month would cover her costs in about six hours.** A monthly version follows only if the trial works. Reader-paid options and podcast sponsorship are set aside until her audience is larger, for the reasons below.

Recommended now: Behind the Counter Story (one-off)

What the business gets	One interview; one long-form story (1,200–2,000 words) in Christine's voice on her website and Substack; 2–3 Instagram and LinkedIn posts; links to the business; a chance to correct facts (not tone) before publishing; the right to reuse the story on its own website and social media, with credit
What readers get	An honest, labelled story about a local hidden gem, from someone with lived experience, not an ad

Evidence it sells	North Shore Mums sells the same "person behind the business" story at $1,500 + GST (North Shore Mums, n.d.-a); CityMag sells bespoke stories; the SA Business Chamber bundles a profile video into $405-a-month membership (South Australian Business Chamber, n.d.)
Christine's time	About 3–5 hours per story (2.2)
Suggested trial price	**$150 per story or $80 for a story** for the first three businesses (our judgement, explained below)
Risks and safeguards	Label every paid story "Paid partnership with [business]" at the top (Ad Standards, 2022); Christine keeps final say on the story; only businesses she would write about anyway

Why $150. Christine wants to cover her costs, not earn a large income, so we set the price from her costs and time rather than from what the market might bear. At about 3 hours a story, $150 pays roughly $50 an hour, and two stories cover her maximum monthly costs of $300. The price sits at the lower end of What's On in Adelaide's $100–400 promotion tiers (Objective 1) and is a tenth of what North Shore Mums charges for a similar story (North Shore Mums, n.d.-a), so it is affordable for a micro business. Because Christine is selling the story rather than a large audience, a modest price is also easier for businesses to accept.

A smaller option. The $80 Short Story gives price-sensitive businesses a way in. It takes about 1.5 hours (our estimate), so it pays about the same hourly rate.

How many stories cover her costs.

If monthly costs are	Stories needed	Christine's time
$100	2 every 3 months	about 2 hours a month
$200	4 every 3 months	about 4 hours a month
$300	2 a month	about 6 hours a month

Four Short Stories a month ($320) would also cover the maximum, in about the same six hours. Either way, Christine can cover her costs without working more hours than she wants.

Next, if the trial works: Monthly Partnership

One story a month for the same business for **three months**, at **$130 a month** (a small discount for committing). Each month uses a different angle (the founder, a product, a supplier). The three-month minimum mirrors 2RPH's 13-week minimum (Objective 1) and The Parenting Couch's three-episode discount (North Shore Mums, n.d.-b). Christine should take **no more than two** monthly partners at once; two partners would bring in $260 a month for about 6 hours of work. Once a producer is in place, each month can add a 10-minute episode and clips.
Later, when the reader list grows reader-side income.

At the median 3% conversion (Campbell, 2026), a paid Substack tier needs about **500 free subscribers** to bring in roughly 15 paying readers. Christine has about 60, so we suggest waiting. The same reader list is where a future short ebook of small-business lessons (no recipes) would be sold, which answers her question about funnels: **free stories → free newsletter → a low-priced ebook**. Each paid business story also brings new readers to that list.

7.3.2 Trial plan and when to decide

Christine should **sell three Behind the Counter Stories over about three months**, then decide using the rules below. The trial is small enough to stop at any time without loss.

→ **Choose three businesses** she already supports and has a connection with, ideally women-led and in Adelaide.

→ **Offer the founding prices ($150 story, $80 Short Story)**, explaining the reuse rights and the "Paid partnership" label.

→ **Record for each story:** hours spent and which AI steps saved time; likes and comments on the related posts (target about 40 each, 2.2); new Substack subscribers that week; whether the business shared or reused the story; and its feedback.

Decide at the end of the trial:

If…	Then…
Each story took about 3 hours or less **and** at least 2 of 3 businesses would buy again	Keep the one-off story and offer one business the Monthly Partnership
Stories took noticeably longer than 3 hours	Drop the social posts from the package or lean more on the AI steps, before considering a higher price
Fewer than 2 businesses would pay again	Ask them why, and offer the $80 Short Story before dropping the idea
Substack reaches about 500 subscribers	Revisit a paid reader tier or the ebook (2.3)

Assumptions and limits of this evidence

Assumption or limit	Why we made it	If it turns out wrong
Christine's costs are at most $300 a month	Confirmed by Christine; we plan for the maximum	Lower costs mean fewer stories are needed
A story with social posts takes about 3 hours	2.5 hours confirmed by Christine; the 30 minutes for social posts is our estimate	The trial records actual hours
Businesses will pay $80–150 for a story with reuse rights	No SA price list exists for this exact service; set from Christine's costs and the examples in 2.2	The trial in 2.4 tests it within three months
Platform audience figures are comparable in size order	Each platform uses its own measure and date (InDaily and CityMag June 2024; others undated)	Comparisons are about scale only, which is how we use them
Per-post engagement for the SA platforms	Not published, and Instagram restricts data without login	We compared formats, frequency and how each platform earns money instead
Engagement and newsletter benchmarks come mainly from US and global data	No Australian equivalents found	Targets are a starting point; Christine's own Instagram Insights should replace them after three months
Several Objective 1 prices (What's On in Adelaide, 2RPH) are taken from our	Not re-checked for this section	Confirm before the final report

VIII. Gap Analysis and Competitor Benchmarking

8.1 Gap between The Food Granny and the market

The comparison shows that the gap is mostly one of reach, consistency and a clear offer. It is not a gap in storytelling. The larger platforms have far bigger audiences and set publishing routines. The Food Granny has a more personal voice and a lower price, but she does not yet make it easy for a business to buy.

Area	Market benchmark	The Food Granny today	Gap
Audience size	InDaily SA: 452,000 monthly readers and 58,000 newsletter subscribers. CityMag: 70,000 online readers and 52,000 newsletter subscribers. The Adelaide Show: 500 to 1,000 downloads per episode	About 60 Substack subscribers, 12 to 41 downloads per episode and about 2,200 Instagram followers	Large. She is far smaller than the other platforms. The Adelaide Show has roughly 20 to 40 times her podcast audience
Publishing rhythm	InDaily daily, CityMag and the SA Business Chamber weekly, The Adelaide Show every 2 to 3 weeks (440 episodes)	Irregular posting, and the last episode came out in May 2026	Large. Readers and sponsors can't rely on when she will publish, and the podcast looks stopped
Brand and channels	Each platform has one name and clear formats	Names, style and topics change from channel to channel. The podcast and Substack don't use "Behind the Counter"	Medium. Her voice is strong, but the channels don't read as one brand
Paid offer	Sponsored and bespoke stories, sponsorship packages and paid membership	No paid offer. Her stories are free	Large. There is nothing for a business to buy

Published pricing	North Shore Mums sells a business story for $1,500 + GST. The SA Business Chamber Gold membership costs $405 a month + GST. InDaily and CityMag quote on request	No prices, and she has no formal process for quoting	Medium. There is no price to compare
Way in for businesses	Media kits, sponsorship pages and membership pages	The website explains what she does but gives no clear way to start working with her	Medium. A business owner can't see the next step
Production capacity	Teams, producers and sales staff	She works alone and has no producer for audio	Large. She can't match the output of larger outlets
Evidence and measurement	Audience figures published in media kits	No demographic data, and engagement figures need a login. No paying clients have been interviewed	Medium. She can't yet show a business what it would gain

Where she is already ahead

→ **Personal voice.**

Her stories feel personal, not promotional. Large outlets often leave the writing to the business.

→ **Fit for micro businesses**

Large outlets are too costly for many small businesses, and a Gold membership is out of reach. She can offer an affordable story for those that can't write their own.

→ **Price**

At $150 a story, the proposed price is a tenth of what North Shore Mums charges for a similar story.

→ **Local focus.**

She writes about Adelaide and South Australia, which businesses in the region value.

8.2 Competitor Strategies

Competitor	What it offers	How it earns	What The Food Granny can learn
InDaily SA	Daily news, specialty newsletters such as Business Insight, and social posts	Sponsored content, newsletters and event sponsorship. Prices on request	It earns from stories about people and businesses, not from audience size alone
CityMag	Long-form stories, a free print magazine, a newsletter and social posts	Sponsored stories that the business writes (800 words) or bespoke stories that CityMag writes. Prices on request	It sells the same product she sells, but only to businesses with a budget. The gap below it is hers
SA Business Chamber	A weekly newsletter, events and member profile videos	A Gold membership at $405 a month + GST that includes a profile video and newsletter exposure	A business story can be bundled into something else businesses already pay for
The Adelaide Show	An interview podcast with written show notes, a short preview video and an email	No sponsorship rates published. The host calls it a “labour of love”	Even a successful local podcast may not earn income, so her podcast should build reputation and connections
North Shore Mums (Sydney)	A “Business Spotlight” story and a podcast with host-read advertisements	$1,500 + GST for a story and $650 + GST for a podcast advertisement	The closest match to her format. Writing is priced separately and higher than audio placemen

Patterns across the competitors

They sell stories across several formats. An article is often paired with a newsletter, social posts or audio.

They price the writing, not the audio. Audio advertising is priced by downloads, so it earns very little at her current audience size.

They keep a regular routine. Daily, weekly or fortnightly publishing builds trust.

They give businesses a clear way to buy. Media kits, packages or membership pages show what is on offer.

Audience size alone doesn’t pay. A loyal audience builds reputation, but income comes from the stories and services sold to businesses.

8.3 Opportunities for Improvement

Opportunity	Gap it closes	How to measure it
1. **Give businesses a clear way in.** Add a "work with me" page on the website and a link in the Instagram profile. Describe the Behind the Counter Story in plain words, with its price	No clear way in, and no paid offer	Enquiries received. The offer is visible on both channels
2. **Test the paid offer.** Sell three Behind the Counter Stories at $150, or an $80 Short Story, to businesses she already knows (Section 9)	No paid offer, and no evidence of willingness to pay	Hours per story, whether businesses would buy again, and their feedback
3. **Make the channels read as one brand.** Use "Behind the Counter" and The Food Granny name on Instagram, Substack and the podcast, with a steady look and focus	Scattered names, style and topics	The same name and style on every channel
4. **Keep a simple publishing rhythm.** Choose a schedule she can keep, and restart the podcast only when it can run steadily	Irregular posting, and a podcast that looks stopped	Posts or episodes published against the schedule
5. **Use channels for what they do best.** Focus on Instagram (local reach), Substack (deep stories and a list she owns), the podcast and LinkedIn (sponsors and partners). Reduce time on X unless it earns a response	Effort that isn't returned	Response per hour spent, by channel

6. Use AI for the routine steps. Transcription, finding quotes and checking spelling, with every sentence written by her	Limited capacity	Hours per story, against the 2.5 to 3 hours now
7. Use grants and mentoring for setup costs. Women in Business Foundations now, the City of Adelaide Major Round if the project has a public city component (closes 23 October 2026), then CBF, Campbelltown and FoundHer in 2027 (Section 6)	Limited budget and limited commercial support	Applications submitted and funding secured
8. Collect evidence as she goes. Track engagement on each story, new subscribers and client feedback. Use Instagram Insights to replace the benchmarks	No audience data, and no evidence for businesses	A simple record kept for every story

Order of work. The first three priorities come before the rest. Without a clear way in, a visible offer and a consistent brand, extra posting won't bring clients. Priorities 4 to 8 support them once the trial has shown what works.

IX. Service Packaging Options with Trade-offs

Based on the market comparison and Christine's current capacity, two service options offer the clearest starting point. Rather than launching several services at once, we recommend testing a simple one-off story first and using the results to decide whether a recurring partnership is worthwhile.

9.1 Understanding Potential B2B Clients: Customer Empathy Map

9.1.1 Target Audience

Building on the customer personas introduced in Section 3, this empathy map focuses on small and micro businesses in South Australia as potential B2B clients of The Food Granny.
The analysis explores these businesses' needs, challenges and expectations. It aims to identify how The Food Granny's storytelling services could address their marketing difficulties and provide a foundation for the service packages proposed in the following sections.

9.1.2 Customer Empathy Map

Table 1. Empathy Map of Potential Business Clients

Dimension	Customer Insights
Think & Feel	• Want to attract more customers and grow their businesses. • Want people to understand what makes their business different. • Need promotion that is useful but still affordable. • Need to balance promotion with the everyday demands of running a business.
See	• A crowded social media environment where it is difficult to stand out. • Many businesses competing for the same customers' attention. • Promotional content that often focuses on products rather than the people and stories behind the business.

Say & Do	• "We need more customers." • Use social media to promote their businesses but may not get the results they want. • Look for affordable ways to improve visibility and reach new customers. • Try to promote their businesses while managing other day-to-day responsibilities.
Pains	• Limited time for marketing and content creation. • Limited marketing budget and marketing skills. • Difficulty identifying and reaching the right customers. • High operating costs. • Limited capacity to commit to large or expensive marketing services.
Gains & Needs	• More customers and stronger visibility. • Better reach to the right audience. • Affordable and manageable promotional support. • Authentic stories that communicate the people, values and purpose behind the business. • A clearer way to show customers what makes their business different. • Promotional support that saves time rather than creating additional work.

Note. This empathy map combines insights from the client consultation with The Food Granny's published content and examples of businesses Christine has featured. As potential paying clients have not yet been directly interviewed about the proposed service, their willingness to pay still needs to be tested.

9.1.3 Key Customer Insights

Limited Time, Budget and Marketing Support

Small businesses want to attract more customers but often lack the time, budget and marketing skills to promote themselves effectively. Although many use social media, some struggle to identify their target audience and create content that stands out. This highlights the need for promotional support that is simple, affordable and easy to manage

More Than Product Promotion

The Food Granny offers more than traditional product promotion by focusing on the people and stories behind local businesses. For example, the Woodlane Pantry feature highlights the founder's purpose and commitment to reducing food waste (Smith, 2026c). Similarly, stories about Discover Adelaide Tours and a local restaurant emphasize personal experiences, authenticity and business identity (Smith, 2026a, 2026b).

These examples demonstrate Christine's strength in telling the stories behind businesses, particularly when owners lack the time or skills to do so themselves. The potential value goes beyond exposure by helping audiences understand the people, purpose and experiences that make each business different.

Affordability Matters

As highlighted during the client consultation, many small businesses face high operating costs and limited marketing budgets, making expensive or long-term promotional services difficult to commit to. A smaller, clearly defined storytelling package could provide a more accessible starting point.

However, potential clients have not yet been directly asked about their willingness to pay. Pricing and demand should therefore be tested through an initial service trial rather than assumed.

9.1.4 Implications for Service Design

The customer insights show that The Food Granny should offer services that are affordable, simple and focused on real business stories. Small businesses often have limited time and money, so the services should be easy to use and should not create extra work for business owners. Christine's strength is telling the stories behind businesses and showing what makes them different. Based on these needs, we suggest two options: a One-Off Business Story Package for businesses that want a single story, and a Monthly Business Partnership for those who want regular storytelling and promotion.

9.1.5 Research Limitations

This empathy map is based on the client consultation, The Food Granny's published content and businesses Christine has featured before. However, we have not directly interviewed potential paying clients about these services. We therefore do not know how much they are willing to pay or which package they would prefer. The Food Granny should test both options with a small number of businesses before deciding on the final services and prices.

9.2 Option 1: One-Off Business Story Package

The One-Off Business Story Package allows a local business to commission a story without making a longer-term commitment.

Possible inclusions:

1. One interview with the business owner
2. One long-form business story

3. Publication on The Food Granny website, Substack or an agreed platform
4. Two to three supporting social media posts
5. Links to the featured business
6. One opportunity to correct information before publication

This option has the lowest commitment and builds directly on Christine's existing interviewing and writing skills. It also allows her to control how many projects she accepts, supporting her preference to keep The Food Granny flexible.

The main trade-off is less predictable income, as each story requires a new client and the time involved may vary. The first few projects should therefore be used to track the actual time spent on interviewing, writing, revisions and client communication before setting a final price.
As these stories involve paid business partnerships, they should also be clearly identified as commercial content to maintain transparency with the audience (Australian Association of National Advertisers [AANA], 2021). Christine should retain editorial control over the final story to protect the authentic voice that differentiates The Food Granny.

Priority: 1 — Recommended starting point

9.3 Option 2: Monthly Business Partnership

If the one-off package receives positive feedback, Christine could offer selected businesses a three-month partnership.

Possible inclusions:

1. One business story each month
2. Regular social media promotion
3. Links and calls to action for the participating business
4. A simple monthly performance summary
5. Optional audio or podcast content when production support is available

Each month could explore a different part of the business, such as the founder, a product, or the people behind the business.

The advantage is more predictable income and a longer relationship with each client. Working with the same business may also reduce the need to find and onboard a new client for every story.
The trade-off is a greater commitment. Regular clients create regular deadlines, which may reduce Christine's flexibility and increase her workload. For this reason, the monthly option should only be introduced after the one-off service has been tested.

Priority: 2 — Next step if the trial works

9.4 Trade-off Comparison

	One-Off Business Story	Monthly Partnership
Income	Less predictable	More predictable
Flexibility	High	Medium
Workload	Low–Medium	Higher
Commitment	One project	Ongoing
Client relationship	Short-term	Longer-term
Best use	Testing demand	Building recurring income
Priority	**Start first**	**Test later**

9.5 Recommended Trial and Next Steps

Before setting the final prices, we recommend that Christine test the One-Off Business Story Package with two or three local businesses she already knows. This would allow her to understand whether businesses are interested in paying for her storytelling services without taking on too much work.

The trial price should be based on the market research in Section 5 and the time Christine needs to complete each story. The price should be agreed with each business before the work begins. During the trial, Christine should record the time spent on each project, collect feedback from business owners and ask whether they would pay for a similar service again.

The results will help Christine decide whether the package is affordable for customers and worth her time. If the trial receives positive feedback and the workload is manageable, she could then test the Monthly Business Partnership with one business. If businesses are not interested or the work takes too much time, Christine should review the price or simplify the service before offering it more widely.

What Christine can do first?

Step	Action
1. Choose 2–3 businesses	Start with businesses she already knows or has previously featured.
2. Make the offer	Offer an interview, one business story and social media promotion at an introductory price agreed before work begins.
3. Produce the story	Interview → Write → Factual check → Publish → Promote. Clearly identify the paid partnership.
4. Ask for feedback	Find out whether the business found the story useful and would purchase the service again at that price.
5. Decide what comes next	If the response is positive and the workload is manageable, invite one business to trial the Monthly Business Partnership. Otherwise, adjust the package or price.

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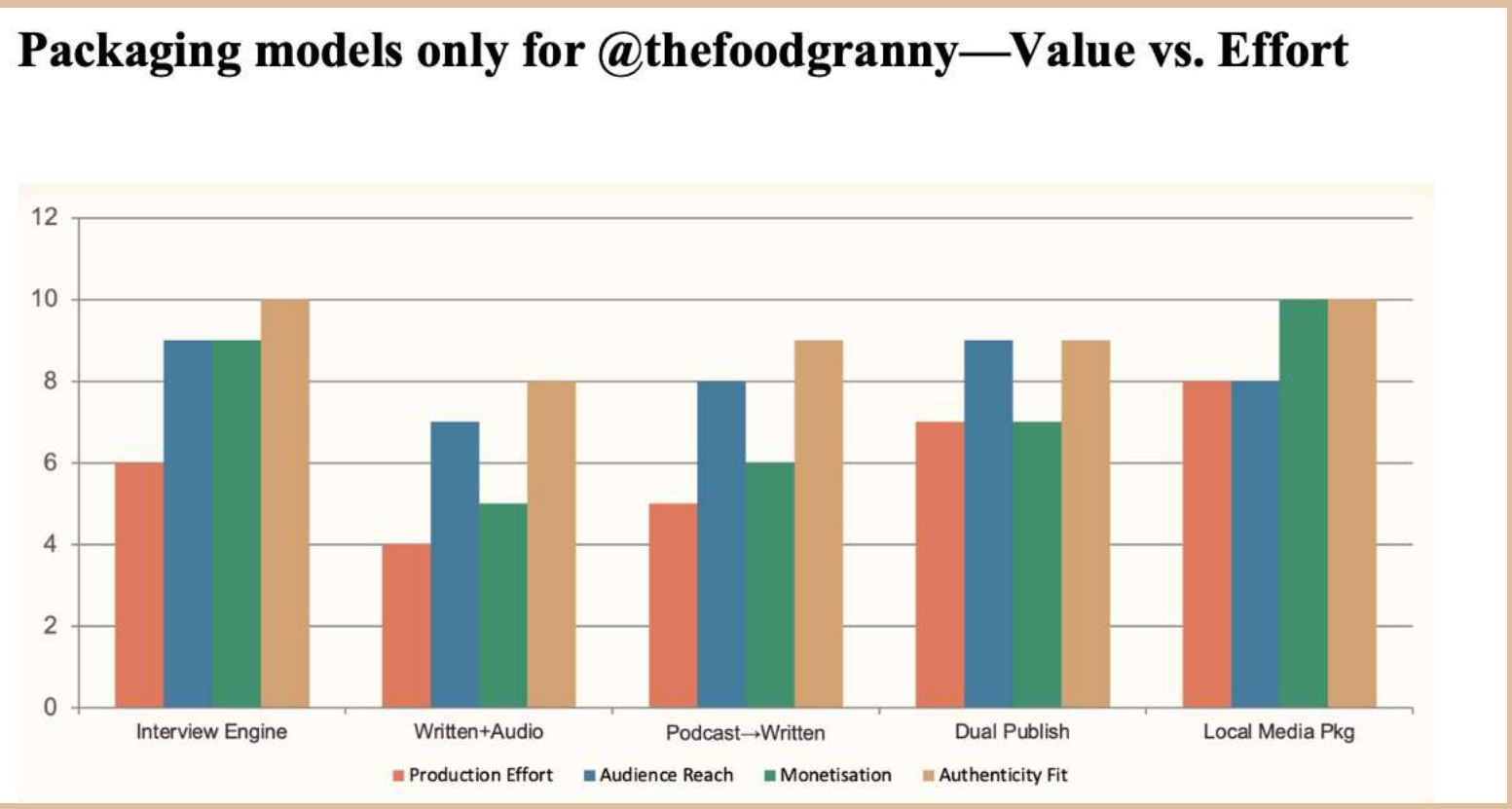
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Appendix 2.1 Team Meetings



Appendix 3.1



Acknowledgement of AI

We acknowledge the use of Microsoft Copilot, published by Microsoft and accessed at https://copilot.microsoft.com, to support refinement of our assessment. We used Copilot to improve the clarity and academic tone of our writing, check alignment with the marking rubric, correct grammatical errors, and adjust the word limit where required. We provided Claude with our own research analysis and asked it to compare it with other platforms and suggest improvements. All ideas, reflections, and final decisions in this assessment are our own.